

Oct 1, 2025

Practus x Amzur - Problem statements for AI solutions

Invited Priyanka Baram Sunil Kodi Deepak Singh Karthick viswanathan

Shradha Prasad Libina Kutty Siva Jamula Teja Kollipara

Attachments 📎 Practus x Amzur - Problem statements for AI solutions

Meeting records 🎙 Recording

Summary

The meeting, attended by Sunil Kodi, libina kutty, Priyanka Baram, and Shradha Prasad, focused on exploring potential use cases for US market data. libina kutty presented five data sources, mainly from Zoho CRM and a visible software, to address problems like statistical forecasting for deal conversions, conversion percentages at different CRM stages, actual time sheet versus budgeted plotting for resource allocation, forecasting hiring costs, and identifying automatable activities. Sunil Kodi highlighted the importance of integrating tools for better planning and real-time project risk and resource availability insights.

Details

- **Meeting Introduction and Participant Roles** The meeting commenced with greetings between Sunil Kodi, libina kutty, and Priyanka Baram, followed by Shradha Prasad joining late due to a Google Meet notification issue. Shradha Prasad introduced libina kutty, explaining that libina kutty actively manages the sales funnel, time sheeting, and data hygiene at their practice. libina kutty also works closely with the delivery head to ensure projects are profitable and prospects are converting. Shradha Prasad stated that libina kutty owns the entire

data piece and would lead the discussion on the data sets to explore potential use cases for the US market.

- **Data Presentation and Problem Statements** libina kutty presented five data sources, primarily from Zoho CRM and a visible software, to address various problem statements. The key problem statements included statistical forecasting for deal conversions, conversion percentages at different CRM stages, and actual time sheet versus budgeted plotting for resource allocation. Other issues covered were forecasting hiring costs and identifying activities that could be automated.
- **Forecasting and Hiring Cost Analysis** libina kutty detailed the need for forecasting team hiring based on project trends and CRM data, emphasizing that people costs are a significant chunk for a consulting firm. Sunil Kodi inquired if projects are of a similar nature, to which Priyanka Baram clarified that tasks within projects are standardized to a great extent, even if project mandates vary. The goal is to determine if existing resources can accommodate new projects or if hiring is needed.
- **Automation of Activities** libina kutty explained the objective of identifying automatable tasks using skill mapping data and visible time sheets. They sought insights on what percentage of activities could be automated based on tasks performed by the delivery team. Sunil Kodi provided an example of automating business requirements document preparation in their experience, and libina kutty confirmed their requirement was similar, aiming to free up manpower from repetitive tasks like tally entries.
- **Client Retention Metrics and CRM Data Fields** libina kutty also included "conversion effectiveness at company level" as a metric, focusing on the percentage of repeating clients, essentially client retention. They then delved into the "deals archive" data, explaining columns such as deal ID, deal owner, deal amount, project name, and various CRM stages. They mentioned that deal IDs might be duplicated if multiple team members work on the same deal, but project names would remain consistent.
- **Detailed CRM Data and Stage Progression** libina kutty further elaborated on the CRM data, including the probability of conversion, deal creation and modification times, currency conversion requirements for USD to INR, and lead sources. They also covered details like industry focus, client type, and crucial dates such as proposal sent dates, original expected closure dates, and mandate start/end

dates for converted clients. The data also provides insights into payment methods and business unit segmentation between India and the US.

- **CRM Stage History and Data Consistency** libina kutty explained the "stage history archive," which tracks every movement of a deal through its stages. They clarified that while project names can be the same, the deal ID is unique to each entry, even if two people work on the same deal. Sunil Kodi noted instances where a deal was lost and then won back, indicating dynamic deal progression. libina kutty also highlighted that active CRM usage and consistent data updates began around September 2024, impacting the reliability of stage duration days for earlier periods.
- **Visible Data and Resource Allocation** libina kutty introduced the "visible data," where team members update weekly time sheets, but clarified that this system is not integrated with the CRM. They explained that there is no common denominator between visible data and CRM data, making direct linking of projects challenging. However, libina kutty believes linking is not necessary for the requested metrics, such as identifying automatable activities, as task names and types from visible data can be used.
- **Actual vs. Budgeted Plotting and Bandwidth Visibility** libina kutty addressed the problem of actual visible time sheets versus budgeted plotting, explaining that plotting is done at the beginning of a project to determine which projects team members can update time for. The current gap is that team members can update more time than they are budgeted for, leading to inaccurate visibility of available bandwidth for new projects. Sunil Kodi summarized this as needing real-time visibility of planned versus actual time and bandwidth availability, as well as predictive analysis for future hiring needs based on project types, tasks, and existing resource capacity.
- **Next Steps and Data Review** Sunil Kodi confirmed that their AI team colleague, Karthik, had also reviewed the data and would conduct a more thorough internal review. They plan to assess if any data restructuring is required for building a pilot and will communicate which problem statements can be addressed given the available data. Sunil Kodi emphasized the importance of integrating tools for better planning and real-time highlighting of project risks and resource availability issues for future client engagements.

Suggested next steps

- ☐ Sunil Kodi will go through the data again in a couple of days.
- ☐ libina kutty will add the stage definitions to the sheet and share them.
- ☐ Sunil Kodi will review the data, select one or two tasks from the visible data to showcase automation potential, and determine if any massaging or structuring is required to build a pilot.
- ☐ Sunil Kodi will inform libina kutty which problem statements can be showcased and if the available data is sufficient.

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